PROMINENT POLITICAL & NATIONALIST LEADERS (ICSE GRADE 8)

Grade 8 ICSE Social Studies (Mumbai) | Quick Revision Notes + Comparative Table + Practice Q&A

1. QUICK REVISION NOTES — MODERATE, ASSERTIVE & GANDHIAN LEADERS

1. Dadabhai Naoroji (1825–1917) – "Grand Old Man of India"

- Educated at Elphinstone Institution, Mumbai; founding member of the Indian National Congress (1885), thrice its President (1886, 1893, 1906), and first Indian elected to the **British House of Commons** (1892) (Britannica).
- Authored ***Poverty and Un-British Rule in India* (1901)**, formulating the **Drain of Wealth Theory** that exposed how colonial rule siphoned off India's economic surplus.

2. Lokmanya Bal Gangadhar Tilak (1856–1920) – Leader of Assertive Nationalism

- Born in Ratnagiri (Maharashtra) and died in Bombay (1 August 1920); hailed by Mahatma Gandhi as the **"Maker of Modern India"** (Britannica) and key leader of the **Lal–Bal–Pal** trio.
- Championed **Swaraj** (Self-Rule), Swadeshi, and Boycott; revived public Ganesh Chaturthi and Shivaji festivals in Maharashtra for mass mobilization and co-launched the **Home Rule Movement (1916)**.

3. Sir Pherozeshah Mehta (1845–1915) – "Lion of Bombay"

- Prominent Moderate nationalist, barrister, founding member of the INC, and President of its **1890 Calcutta session** (Britannica).
- Architect of the municipal charter for Bombay (earning him the title *"Father of Municipal Government in Bombay"*) and founder of the English daily ***The Bombay Chronicle***.

4. Mahatma Gandhi (1869–1948) – Leader of the Mass Freedom Struggle

- Made Mani Bhavan on Laburnum Road, Gamdevi, Mumbai, his political headquarters for 17 years (**1917–1934**) before it became a national museum in 1955.
- Transformed the INC into a mass movement using **Satyagraha** (nonviolent resistance), leading the Non-Cooperation (1920), Salt Satyagraha (1930), and Quit India (1942) campaigns.

2. COMPARATIVE TABLE – EASY TO REMEMBER

Feature	Dadabhai Naoroji	Bal Gangadhar Tilak	Pherozeshah Mehta	Mahatma Gandhi
Popular Title	Grand Old Man of India	Lokmanya ("Revered by the People")	Lion of Bombay	Mahatma ("Great Soul"); Father of Nation
Nationalist Phase	Early Nationalist (Moderate)	Assertive Nationalist (Lal–Bal–Pal)	Early Nationalist (Moderate)	Gandhian Mass Era (1919–1948)
Mumbai Connection	Elphinstone College; 1885 INC founder	Swadeshi & Ganeshotsav mobilization	Framed Bombay Municipal Charter	Mani Bhavan HQ (1917–34); Gowalia Tank
Key Contribution	Drain of Wealth Theory; first Indian MP in UK	Demand for *Swaraj* & Home Rule (1916)	1890 INC President; *The Bombay Chronicle*	*Satyagraha*, Khadi, Non-Cooperation & Quit India

3. PRACTICE QUESTIONS & ANSWER KEY (ICSE EXAM PREP)

Q1. Who authored *Poverty and Un-British Rule in India* (1901) and became the first Indian MP in the British Parliament? — **Ans:** Dadabhai Naoroji ("Grand Old Man of India").

Q2. Which two public festivals did Bal Gangadhar Tilak revive in Maharashtra to build nationalist unity? — **Ans:** The public Ganesh Chaturthi festival and the Shivaji festival.

Q3. Why is Pherozeshah Mehta called the "Lion of Bombay," and where was Gandhi's Mumbai headquarters (1917–1934)? — **Ans:** Mehta framed Bombay's municipal charter and led civic reforms; Gandhi's Mumbai headquarters was at Mani Bhavan.

MEMORY TIP: Remember the 4 Leaders across the 3 ICSE History Eras — **N-M-T-G**: *"Moderates (**N**aoroji & **M**ehta) petitioned → Assertive (**T**ilak) demanded Swaraj → **G**andhi led Satyagraha from Mani Bhavan!"*